DENNIS G. PEZAN

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EDUCATION

B.S. in Operations Research, **United States Military Academy** Expected 2029

- Minor in Artificial Intelligence ◇ Finance Specialization ◇ CQPA: 3.571 ◇ Dean's List (Fall 2025, Spring 2026) ◇ Stokes Writing Fellow ◇ Sea to Shining Sea Fellow

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Undergraduate Researcher, Department of Mathematical Sciences, USMA 2026 - Present

- Modeling adversary interdiction of Taiwan's crude oil supply with LTC Matthew Webb, extending his reinforcement-learning approach to maximum-flow network interdiction
- Built a 57-node, 79-edge open-source network with sourced capacities and seven costed adversary actions, verified against an independent max-flow calculation

Research Intern, Transformation Decision Analysis Center, Fort Lee, VA 2026

- Summer AIAD internship; redesigned the reward function for a PPO reinforcement-learning resupply agent in Logistics Battle Command, the Army's sustainment simulation
- Built diagnostic tools that exposed four reward flaws; the retrained agent more than tripled requests filled and beat a hand-coded priority-aware baseline across 101 seeds
- Presented findings to TDAC branch chiefs at Fort Lee and, by call, to the Naval Postgraduate School

Independent Study in Machine Learning, Department of Mathematical Sciences, USMA 2025 - 2026

- Independent study of decision trees, bagging, and random forests (MA289) under LTC Patrick Kuiper; built an interactive research site and presented findings to officers

PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

Sea to Shining Sea Domestic AIAD, Defense Technology and Innovation 2026

- Held in-depth discussions with leaders at Palantir, Stanford's Gordian Knot Center, OpenAI, Apple, and Meta on how defense technology is developed, procured, and fielded
- Observed technology integration at the 4th Infantry Division and U.S. Northern Command

LEADERSHIP AND SERVICE

Cadet-in-Charge, MA103 Tutoring, Center for Enhanced Performance, USMA 2026 - Present

- Lead the full tutor staff for MA103, a core course with 1,010 cadets

Writing Consultant, Mounger Writing Center, USMA

- Selected as a Stokes Writing Fellow to coach cadets on strengthening the rhetoric of their writing

Member, CLD-STEM Outreach Program, USMA 2025 - Present

- Bring hands-on STEM projects to 800+ students across the Chicagoland and Greater Los Angeles areas

Cadet Ambassador, Cadet Ambassador Program, USMA 2025 - Present

- Represent West Point in outreach to prospective cadets

Department Manager, McDonald's, Plainfield, IL 2022 - 2024

- Promoted at age 16; scheduled 80+ employees weekly, managed $20,000+ in weekly supply orders, and held the store's labor metric at or below 23.5% month over month

SKILLS

Python (PyTorch, scikit-learn), SQL, Java ◇ Reinforcement learning, network optimization ◇ Spanish (fluent)